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Project Overview & Scenario

For this project, I stepped into the role of a **Digital Ambassador**, balancing technical development with professional communication. I began by refining my technical workflow on **HackerRank**, using the **"Solve Me First"** challenge to ensure my logic and environment were solid. This foundation was then applied to building my professional digital presence on **LinkedIn and GitHub**, where I focused on presenting my skills and projects to a global audience.

To put my digital literacy into practice, I researched **UPI fraud**—specifically looking at how scammers use psychological pressure rather than just technical hacks. I converted this research into a **Google Form awareness quiz** to test my peers' ability to spot sophisticated red flags. Finally, I practiced the "gold standard" of workplace communication by drafting **two professional emails** following strict formal protocols. This task was a reality check on how much tone and structure matter when communicating with stakeholders or professors.

Academic & Professional Impact: These activities bridged the gap between "knowing" and "doing." Mastering professional email etiquette and setting up my GitHub early gives me a massive head start for internships. Meanwhile, the Google Form project taught me how to analyze data and communicate risks clearly—skills that will be vital for any leadership role in my future career.

task 1 write up

To build the graphic, I stuck with **Canva** because I wanted that "windowed" UI look that feels like someone’s actual computer screen. My design, "Level Up Your Digital Game," is basically a roadmap for students. On the left, I grouped "Must Have" apps like **Notion** and **Discord** because those are the ones my friends and I actually use to stay organized and talk about projects. On the right, I added a section on the "Permanent Resume" to remind people that GitHub and LinkedIn are just as important as a physical CV these days.

One thing I found really interesting while putting this together was the section on the **digital footprint**. It’s kind of scary to realize that while a physical mistake might be forgotten, anything we do online is pretty much permanent. The hardest part was actually the layout. I spent way too much time trying to get the text to fit inside those little browser windows without it looking cluttered. I wanted it to be something someone would actually stop and read, not just a boring poster. In the end, I think the minimalist grid style really helps the main message of being "Responsible and Critical" stand out.

task 2 write up

To build a strong professional foundation over the next four years, I have selected **LinkedIn**, **GitHub**, and **Kaggle** as my primary digital platforms. Each serves a distinct purpose in my growth as a developer and researcher. **LinkedIn** acts as my "living resume" and primary networking hub, where I can connect with industry professionals, follow tech trends, and showcase my project milestones. **GitHub** is my essential version-control repository; it is where I host my codebase, contribute to open-source projects, and demonstrate my technical proficiency to potential employers through a public portfolio. Finally, **Kaggle** provides a competitive environment to sharpen my data science and machine learning skills through real-world datasets and community challenges.

Over the next four years, I plan to use these platforms in a synchronized loop. I will use **GitHub** daily to document my academic and personal coding projects, ensuring a consistent "green streak" of contributions. I will participate in one **Kaggle** competition per semester to apply my classroom theory to complex data problems. Finally, I will share the results of these projects and competition rankings on **LinkedIn** to build a professional brand. By graduation, this ecosystem will provide tangible proof of my technical evolution and readiness for the industry.

task 3 write up

For this stage of the project, I utilized HackerRank to refine my technical workflow. Rather than jumping into complex algorithms immediately, I focused on completing the introductory challenges, such as "Solve Me First." While I have prior experience with coding, using these specific tasks allowed me to practice navigating the platform’s unique interface, understanding its automated testing environment, and ensuring my environment configurations were seamless.

Building this familiarity is a practical step in streamlining how I approach future assignments. By practicing the mechanics of the platform through these initial challenges, I ensured that I can focus entirely on logic and optimization when I move on to more difficult problems.

Academic Impact Academically, tools like HackerRank are essential for building procedural fluency. They provide a standardized environment to test my logic against hidden edge cases, which is a significant step up from local debugging. This practice will help me bridge the gap between "making code work" and "making code efficient," a distinction that is vital for success in higher-level computer science modules. Mastering the platform early means I can collaborate more effectively in technical labs and approach my upcoming exams with a more disciplined, test-driven mindset.

task 4 write up

A good example of a digital communication breakdown is the 2012 Knight Capital Group trading glitch. A technician failed to copy new software code to a single server out of eight, and there was no written confirmation or "all-clear" protocol in place. When the system went live, the mismatched code triggered a massive wave of accidental trades. Because the team relied on informal, fragmented digital updates during the deployment, they didn't realize the error until the company had lost $440 million in just 45 minutes.

To prevent this, they should have used a centralized deployment checklist and a formal sign-off process. Instead of assuming the update was successful, a simple automated "handshake" or a mandatory peer-review message on a platform like Slack or Jira would have flagged the discrepancy. Clear, documented communication turns a "guess" into a verified fact, which is essential when the stakes are that high.

task 5 write up

What surprised me most during this research wasn't the typical "enter your PIN" scams—since I've always known that receiving money requires zero action on my part. Instead, I was struck by the "SIM Swap" and "Service Request" sophisticated fraud. I hadn't realized that scammers could potentially deactivate someone's SIM card by posing as them at a retail store, effectively hijacking their UPI-linked mobile number without ever touching their phone. Seeing how a physical security flaw in a telecom provider could bypass all my digital precautions was definitely a "wow" moment.

Because I'm already careful with links and pins, the habit I am changing is my oversharing of "minor" personal details. I realized that even posting a screenshot of a delivery issue or a bank complaint on X (Twitter) with my phone number or order ID visible gives scammers the "hooks" they need to call me and sound legitimate. My new rule is to scrub all metadata and personal identifiers from any public post, no matter how small the issue seems. Even if I'm too smart to click a link, I don't want to give them the data they need to build a convincing story in the first place.

Conclusion

Ultimately, this project was about more than just completing tasks; it was about shifting my perspective from a student to a professional. Whether I was troubleshooting a simple challenge on **HackerRank**, perfecting the margins on my **Canva** templates, or drafting high-stakes **professional emails**, the common thread was precision.

Researching **UPI fraud** specifically taught me that technical knowledge is useless without a skeptical, security-first mindset. By building my **GitHub** and **LinkedIn** presence now, I've moved beyond theory and started creating a tangible digital footprint. Moving forward, I feel much more confident navigating the professional world with the right tools and habits.

References

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